

Chapter 23

Re-positioning the human translator as the future expert of GenAI translation in the translation classroom: The results of a collaborative study

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With the launch of ChatGPT in 2022, which allowed the production of translation through a prompt-based *dialogue* between the human and the GenAI, the early characterisations of translation as “human-computer interaction” (OBriensharon) and “dance of agency” (OLOHANmaeve) have become realities in the fullest sense. In previous research, it has been suggested that educators and students can collaborate to understand how to create “human added value” (MASSEY) and raise the students’ “self-concept” (Haro-Soler and Kiraly 2019) as human translators in emergent MT tasks (SÖBNA). Translator educators should once again work in collaboration with students to explore the human-GenAI *dialogue*. For this aim, a research experiment was conducted where graduate level students and the educator collaborated to explore the dynamics of prompt engineering (Yamada) as the emerging job role in the field of GenAI translation. The results showed that the experiment helped the students diagnose not only the strengths and weaknesses of the GenAI but also that of themselves, who re-acknowledged the need for the intervention, editing and evaluation of a professional human translator in turning a raw GenAI output to a functioning translation. They also re-evaluated their human added value and self-concept as educated and experienced human translators, highlighting the sense of empowerment and responsibility they felt as the human decision-makers in the prompt engineering process, addressing, nevertheless, areas of self-improvement such as developing skills to communicate with the GenAI, which is distinct from communicating with a human being. The results also indicated that the established holistic set of skills of a trained professional human translator was regarded a prerequisite for effective prompt engineering, which should be considered by the translator educator who now has the task of educating the

students so that they can cautiously but confidently communicate and dance with the GenAI.

1 Introduction

The impact of machine translation (MT) on the translation profession and translator education has been profound in the last decade, so has been the research into this impact. One prominent focus in the literature has been on the tense relationship between the human translator and the machine/technology, which was conceptualised, on the basis of **Pickering's** notion, as “dance of agency” by **OLOHANmaeve**, who drew attention to the “decentring” (354) of the human agent in the context of translation. **OBriensharon** characterised translation as “human-computer interaction”, defining what had been happening then as a “shift in paradigm” (119) and pointed out the potential of the “dialogue” (120) between the human and the technology.

The dynamics of the human-machine relationship was further elaborated on, with a focus on the emotional dimension inherent in this relationship, by **Ruokonen**, who found out that the human agents were “willing” and “reluctant” at the same time in terms of assigning agency to the machine and that the relationship between the human and the machine is too “complex” to be reduced to “simplified man versus machine conceptions” (321). In similar vein, **cadwell** observed that positive and negative perceptions of MT co-existed on the part of the human translators, which were respectively related to reduced effort and increased inspiration and a concern on the negative influence of MT on human creativity (312). The authors also argued that the dance of agency between the human and the machine was a symbiotic one as they mutually feed and shape each other and the “distinction between the human and the material agent” is blurred (303).

The practical consequences of the pervasive integration of MT technologies into the global translation industry and the involved economic aspect has also been explored. **Moorkens**, for instance, noted the negative consequences of the freelance employment model, increasingly adopted in the global translation industry, in terms of prices and isolation (465), and pointed out that the focus of studies should be on how the human translator actually works with MT (471). Similarly, **Vieira** found out that rather than involving an “intrinsic negativity to the tech-

nology”, the translators’ perceived threat concerned business practices (15).

Another focus in the related literature has been on the need for a re-definition of the human translator’s professional profile. **Sakamoto** underlined the necessity of the “redefinition of the concept of a ‘translator’, and consequently ‘translation’ per se” (68) on the grounds that “the notion of ‘translation’ is now being challenged by the growth of technologies” (69). The author also noted that attention should be paid to the uncertainties related to the legal requirements in MT use, pricing for post-editing, and post-editors’ profiles and skills (63-66). Based on a comprehensive analysis of the emerging needs and requirements in the translation sector, which was conducted with the aim of addressing the “distance between teaching and professional practice” (334) in the context of MT competences, **gaspari** reported “a strong need for an improvement in quality assessment methods, tools and training, underlining the “growing uptake of MT and the perceived increase of its prevalence in future workflows” (333).

Research into the possible methods of integrating the new skills, abilities and competencies, which should be possessed by the human translator in the MT age, into translator education and the concomitant need to re-profile translator education has been extensive and substantial. For instance, **dohetry** designed an SMT syllabus, which foregrounded the “empowerment” (296) of the human translator, enabling him/her to intervene in and add value to the SMT workflows (296-297), during which the authors reported to have faced legal, ethical and technical obstacles (**KennyDorothy**:288). This “empowering” approach has further been extended by **Mellinger**, who proposed a holistic, “cross-module or cross-curricular integration” of post-editing and machine translation “to avoid compartmentalisation of various competences and skillsets” (284). The author also suggested the inclusion, in courses on translation practice, of “controlled authoring, terminology management, engine tuning, and post-editing” as the four areas of content that are “representative of many of the skills mentioned in recent works on machine translation pedagogy” (284). **pymonline** drew attention to the identification of “automation-resistant skills” and their integration into translator education.

The measures to be taken by translator educators to empower students and help them become “aware of their usefulness in order to maximise their agency as translators” (375) has also been the focus in a study by **MMoorkens**, who designed a translation evaluation exercise to enable the students to “demystify NMT output” (376). Based on a rethinking of translator competence in the MT

age, SÖB designed a learning practice to help students “raise their awareness of their professional self-concept as human translators” (3) and suggested the consideration of “human translator competence” and “human translation meta competence” (18). Nitzke proposed a novel “post-editing competence model”, which included the core competences of “risk assessment competence”, “strategic competence”, “consulting competence” and “service competence” (248). Işın investigated translation students’ “perceived difficulties and benefits” in the context of “post-editing oriented neural machine translation error annotation and quality evaluation” (100).

Exploring the “dynamics of the human-machine dance in the translation classroom” (377), SÖBNA designed a learning experiment to enable the students to carry out emergent MT-related tasks of post-editing, pre-editing and error annotation. The authors reported that the experiment helped the majority of the participating students “raise awareness of their self-concept as human agents and of the human added value they can create while dancing with the machine (387).

The above outlined examples of the studies focusing on the impact of machine translation (MT) on the translation profession and translator education show that translation studies (TS) research has indeed come a long way to come to terms with and adapt itself to the paradigm shift (OBriensharon) induced by the all-pervasive technologization of translation, speeding up especially after the launch of the neural machine translation (NMT) technology in 2016.

Yet, the year 2022 came with another, unprecedented challenge to be faced and embraced by the practitioners and educators of translation. With the launch of ChatGPT in 2022 (OpenAI), which allowed the production of translation through a prompt-based dialogue between the human and the generative-AI (GenAI), the early characterisations of translation as “human-computer interaction” (OBriensharon) and “dance of agency” (OLOHANmaeve) have become realities in the fullest sense, posing new questions and opening new areas of research for the TS community, especially for educators and researchers of translator education.

In the above-cited previous research (SÖBNA), it has been noted that in the face of the rapid advancements in MT technologies and the uncertainties concerning their integration into education, a re-positioning of the educator is as necessary as the re-positioning of the human translator (389). It has also been argued that

such re-positioning involves an “awareness of the fact that the translator educator has the primary task of diagnosing and promoting emergent areas of human added value creation in the MT age”, and that this can only be achieved by restructuring the translation classroom as a “platform of collaborative learning, where all involved can work together to discover what remains and will remain human in the MT age” (389).

In the face of another paradigm shift induced nowadays by the introduction of ChatGPT and other GenAI tools, translator educators should once again work in collaboration with students to explore the dynamics of working with these tools. Motivated by this very need, the present chapter presents the results of a collaborative research experiment designed to explore the dynamics of the human-GenAI dialogue and find the pathways to be followed in incorporating the gained insights into translator education.

The remainder of the chapter is structured as follows: first, a discussion on the unprecedented practical and theoretical challenges posed by GenAI technology in terms of the very *raison d'être* of the human translation is presented; second, information on the design and implementation of the experiment is given; third, the data obtained from the experiment is analysed; fourth, a discussion of the results is presented together with conclusions and suggestions for future research.

2 Human added value and the human translator's self-concept in the age of GenAI: Re-visiting the interpretive task and responsibility of the human translator

ChatGPT is a GenAI tool powered by a large language model (LLM) and has not been developed specifically for language translation. However, the revolution it brought to translation is of great significance as the tool takes prompts from the human agent and hence allows him/her to produce a translation by providing the tool with contextual information and guidance, i.e. to perform prompt engineering (Yamada). This was certainly not the case with MT, which renders the GenAI technology a real breakthrough and hence requires translator educators to ask and try to answer new questions about the human-technology interaction.

Yet, in the opinion of the author of the present chapter, this endeavour should not attempt to re-invent the wheel. It should rather involve re-thinking and/or

re-utilising the relevant insights already gained in the context of MT, especially those that concern the integration of MT into translator education in a way to empower the human translator to create human added value, as outlined in the previous section (see Introduction). It should further involve contemplating the changing and deepening challenge posed against *what is human in translation* by technology, this time in the form of GenAI, which, unlike MT, creates the illusion of having an actual dialogue with a non-human agent which pretends to understand, interpret and produce a linguistic message.

This new form of challenge should urge us to re-visit the interpretive task and responsibility of the human translator. Accordingly, the approach presented here is performing a backward reading: rather than giving priority to the investigation of the performance, potential and/or limitations of GenAI, what the present study proposes is the instrumentalization of the human-GenAI *dialogue* in order to try to re-see *what is/will remain human* in translation in a brighter light and find ways to incorporate it into translator education, this time in the age of GenAI.

In a seminal contribution by **MasseyKiraly** titled “The Future of Translator Education: A Dialogue”, Kiraly states that “transcoding (the *mechanical replacement* of linguistic units from a list with corresponding units from a parallel list) is not at the *heart* of translation at all” (16, emphasis mine) and that although in the future the translation profession will be “different”, it is “certainly not going to disappear - unless at some point in our evolution we no longer need to *interpret* texts” (16, emphasis mine).

It is of no coincidence that Kiraly highlights the act of interpreting as the *raison d'être* of the human translator, which echoes the hermeneutical approach applied to translation by **Schleiermacher** in his infamous Address titled “On the Different Methods of Translation” (1813/1977). According to **HermansTeo**, in Schleiermacher’s thought, the sole option for the translator is “to act as the hermeneuticist does: to work to attain the best possible understanding of the foreign text which nevertheless remain foreign, and present to the reader [...] exactly that understanding” (101-102). Accordingly, the meaning of a text is not encoded in a text to be decoded by the translator, rather it should be interpreted by the translator to attain the best possible understanding, which constitutes the hermeneutical task of the translator. The translator is then required to present this understanding to the reader, which, according to Herman’s reading of Schleiermacher, “exceeds hermeneutics” (99). In similar vein, **Şerban** underline that in Schleiermacher’s

approach, the meeting between the author and the reader is “mediated and orchestrated by the translator” and the translator assumes “the most active mediating role” (295).

Although the hermeneutical approach is of critical importance in that it allows room for active mediation to the translator, a specific conceptualization by **arrojo** of the “inevitable interference” (18) of the translator in the context of translation ethics could further the attempt to re-see *what is human in translation*. **Arrojo** views translation ethics in terms of the relationship between the “authorial power” of the translator and his/her “ethical responsibility” (18). Based on a post-modern view of “language and subject”, the author underlines that as “no reading can ever aspire to repeat or protect someone else’s text, translators necessarily have the right to exercise their authorial power ‘as long as their game is played up front’ (**berman**:93, cited in **simon**:36 in **arrojo**:18).” In the view of the author, “[s]uch ‘right’ implies, an ethical responsibility which parallels that of ‘original authors’” (18).

In the wake of an emerging GenAI paradigm, this line of thought can be followed by the researchers and educators of translation to foreground the human translator’s interpretive task and the accompanying responsibility with the aim of exploring the human added value (**MASSEY**) and the human translator’s self-concept (**DonaldKirály**; 2000, **haro** and **MasseyKirály**) in the GenAI age.

Drawing careful attention to the human aspect of added value, **MASSEY** characterises human added value as being “manifest in translational decision-making and problem-solving on a conceptual level that transcends the surface lexical realisations by which meaning is conveyed in source and target texts” (39). He also adds that “the added value that human translators can and do bring to bear resides in their socio-cultural, socio-technical 4EA cognition, as opposed to disembodied, de-contextualised artificial intelligence’ (39). In doing so, the author re-visits **Venuti**’s (2019) advocacy of the “hermeneutical model of understanding translation not as ‘the reproduction or transfer of an invariant that is contained in or caused by the source text’ but as ‘an interpretive act that inevitably varies source-text form, meaning, and effect’” and **pym2003**’s (2003) “minimalist definition of translation competence as ‘the ability to generate a series of more than one viable target text (TT1, TT2 ... TTn) for a pertinent source text (ST); the ability to select only one viable TT from this series, quickly and with justified confidence’” (**Massey** 2021:51).

The delineation by MASSEY of the added value of the human translator vis-à-vis the AI strongly captures the conceptualisation of the human translator as an agent who has the hermeneutical task and power of interpreting and bears the responsibility of his/her interpretive act, which is quite impossible for the “dis-embodied, de-contextualised artificial intelligence’ (39)”. And hence is the significance of paying an unprecedented attention, in the GenAI age, to the translator’s “self-concept” (**haro**), which includes “the image of the translator’s social role”, “the translator’s appraisal of his or her competency for translating a particular text” and “an understanding of *responsibility* towards the other actors in the translation context of situation” (261, emphasis mine). Thus, the constructs human added value and the (human) translator’s self-concept, the author of the present chapter believes, should constitute the privileged foci in exploring the human-GenAI *dialogue* and incorporating the gained insights into translator education in way to help the students in the translation classrooms raise their self-concepts (**haro**:261-262) as human translators whose *raison d’être* is to perform the hermeneutical task of interpreting and bear the resulting responsibility. It is with this focus in mind that the collaborative research experiment, the design and implementation of which are reported below, has been conducted.

3 Design and implementation of the collaborative research experiment

The research experiment, the results of which is reported in the present study, was designed following the tenets of the collaborative research model, implemented by **haro** on the grounds of the social constructivist and emergentist approach to translator education (**KiarlyDon**), where the authors collaboratively worked with translation students “to investigate topics in the domain of Translation Psychology with the goal of having teacher-researchers learn about the translator’s psychological ‘self’ right along with their students” (256). Accordingly, the research experiment presented here was collaboratively performed by graduate level translation students, who participated in the research on voluntary basis, and a translator educator (also the author of the present chapter) with the aim of exploring the dynamics of the human-GenAI interaction as human translators work with GenAI tools as prompt engineers. The student-researchers group consisted of five PhD students with previous translation education and experience and near-native English language proficiency enrolled in the Translation Studies PhD Programme at Yıldız Technical University, Turkey. The educator-researcher was an associate professor of Translation Studies at the

same university.

In the research process, the student-researchers and the educator-researcher collectively decided on the design of the task of prompt engineering in three sessions held online in June 2024. After the design is agreed upon, the student-researchers performed the task individually and reported on their learning/research processes through self-reflexive accounts of their experience.

The initial decisions to be made in the recorded online discussions concerned the selection of the source texts and the GenAI tool to be used to translate the texts through crafting and, when necessary, curating prompts, i.e. prompt engineering (Yamada) in order to pre-process, initiate, produce, edit and evaluate translations so that an output of intended desire and with intended function is achieved. The free version of OpenAI's ChatGPT was collectively decided to be used. As for the source texts, two English texts, an essay and a book description, were selected on the grounds that both texts were of mixed forms between expressive and operative text types, also having the features of an informative text type (Katharina:124-125). The first source text was an essay by Anna Quindlen, which was titled "The Name is Mine" and published in her "Life in the 30s" column in *The New York Times* (quindlen1987name). The second source text was the book description of *The Time Regulation Institute*, the English translation of Ahmet Hamdi Tanpınar's Turkish novel titled *Saatleri Ayarlama Enstitüsü*, translated by Alexander Dawe and Maureen Freely and published in 2014 (PENGUIN).

Next came the decisions to be made concerning the translation briefs and the general principles of prompt engineering. First, the educator-researcher provided the student-researchers with the existing (albeit limited, due to the fact that the topic is new) literature on prompt engineering, about which opinions were exchanged in the first two online sessions. Drawing on the discussions, the educator-researcher then drafted a guideline for the task and sent it to the student-researchers for evaluation. In the third session, the draft was discussed and finalized collectively.

Another decision to be made concerned whether to use the drafted translation brief as the first prompt in the dialogue with the GenAI tool. Taking into consideration the results of the experiments already conducted in other studies on prompt engineering (e.g. He, Peng, Yamada), it was decided not to include the translation brief in prompt engineering and spare it for the guidance of the human translator-prompt engineer only. In this way, the human translators were

entitled with the responsibility of the translation act although they were supposed to perform this act through prompt engineering. The translation briefs for the first and second source texts were as follows:

Translation Brief 1:

“The Name is Mine” is an essay by Anna Quindlen published in her “Life in the 30s” column in *The New York Times* on March 4, 1987. An online magazine website editor in Turkey needs a Turkish translation of the essay and asks you to translate it into Turkish to publish it on the website. The intended audience for the translation is primarily the adult readers who would be interested in the works of Anna Quindlen, who writes primarily on feminism and family life and is a Pulitzer Prize-winning columnist, journalist and author. The editor asks you to translate the second and ninth paragraphs of the essay as a test translation.

Translation Brief 2:

The source text is the book description of the novel *The Time Regulation Institute*, which is the English translation of the prominent Turkish novelist and poet Ahmet Hamdi Tanpınar’s Turkish novel titled *Saatleri Ayarlama Enstitüsü* (1961), translated by Alexander Dawe and Maureen Freely and published by Penguin Classics in 2014. A Turkish literary scholar asks you to translate the English book description into Turkish in order to examine how the English translation of the book (*The Time Regulation Institute*) is marketed to the English-speaking audience by Penguin Classics.

As for the general principles of prompting, “persona prompt” (He) was selected as the prompting method, i.e. it was decided that prompting would begin with the statement “You are a professional translator”, without specifying a specific domain. It was also decided that prompt engineering would include the following steps: 1) prompting the tool to analyse the source text for the purpose of translation, 2) prompting the tool to translate the source text, 3) prompting the tool to edit its translation through curating prompts where deemed necessary, and 4) prompting the tool to evaluate the quality of and comment on its translation. In order to foreground the responsibility of the human translator, a final step, not included within the scope of the prompt engineering task, was added: post-editing the translation output obtained through prompt engineering to produce the translation end-product. Other than these, no specific prompt statements were drafted in order to allow room to the human translator-prompt engineers

for freedom and creativity in their individual dialogue with the GenAI tool. Thus, five versions of prompt engineering and five translation end-products were obtained for each source text.

After completing the task, the student-researchers wrote reports on their prompt engineering experience, the analysis of which is presented below.

4 Analysis of the results: Towards a deeper awareness of the power of the human translator vis-à-vis the GenAI

After the experiment was completed, the student-researchers wrote retrospective process reports on their experience working with the GenAI by answering the questionnaire (see Appendix 1) drafted by the educator-researcher. On a general basis, the responses indicated that the collaborative research allowed participants to both evaluate the potential impact of GenAI on the translation profession and re-affirm their roles as human agents and experts in translation.

The answers to Question 1, “What is your general assessment of the experiment?”, indicated that most of the participants came to recognize that human intervention is still needed in several respects: One participant (P4) noted that during the experiment she “came to the realisation that human translators still have the final say”. Likewise, another participant (P3) stated that despite the “general conception” that LLMs “are already adequate for daily use or even technical translation at some point”, “they would never be able to replace human translators” in terms of “literary texts” and “mixed forms”. Another participant (P1) stated that human translator’s post-editing is “a necessity rather than a preference”, especially for “restructuring expressive language” and “transferring the style”. Participant 2 highlighted her frustration as the AI tool needed “continuous prompting” to edit its translation “until a final translation, which still needs post-editing” is obtained. Another participant (P5) characterised the experiment as being “educating”, noting that although she had used “ChatGPT on various occasions”, the experiment was the first time that she “actually sat down and tried to generate a translation through prompting”.

The answers to Question 2, “Upon completing the experiment, have you faced any emotional challenges as a human agent collaborating with the GenAI to produce a translation? If yes, what were these challenges?”, showed that most of the participants faced emotional challenges while working with the GenAI tool in

one way or other. The feeling of frustration was addressed by two participants: Participant 1 stated that he got “frustrated” when the AI did not “directly implement” his suggestions and he needed to “provide prompts again”. Another participant (P5) also stated that she “found talking to ChatGPT quite frustrating” and that she realized that she “don’t have the required patience to guide it through everything”. One participant (P2) noted that it was “emotionally exhausting to prompt AI for non-literal translation”, especially “if a word is used figuratively” as it was “challenging to explain the function of the word and design the prompt so as to reach an acceptable translation”. Only one participant (P3) described his feeling as “constant puzzlement” rather than “frustration or anger” as the tool required “an in-depth thought process on how to write the prompts” and that he “felt like the LLM wouldn’t be able to complete the tasks” the way he “wanted it to do”. The emotional challenge expressed by one specific participant (P4) differed from the challenges experienced by the other participants in that the “feeling of stress” experienced by this participant stemmed from her underestimation of the “depth of AI’s analytical capabilities” and its “speed”. The participant (P4) also stated she “experienced a lack of confidence while providing prompts” in the translation of the first source text and “became more comfortable” in the translation of the second source text as she familiarized herself with the tool.

The answers to Question 3, “Upon completing the experiment, what have you discovered about your power vis-à-vis the AI and your self-concept as a human translator?”, revealed that the participants addressed the various aspects of the power of the human translator on the basis of their experience in working with the GenAI. One participant (P3) described his experience by saying that he “felt like” as if he was a “supervisor trying to teach a very intelligent new employee how to conduct the job and how it can improve itself in certain areas”. According to him (P3), the tool can “easily analyse the text” and “find out what kind of strategies could be needed to translate the text for the given audience”, but fails to “produce translation strategies to overcome translation problems” as it remains “too ‘faithful’ to the source text” unless the human user “specifically underlines the problems, provides strategies and solutions”. Similarly, Participant 1 emphasized the significance of the “review and intervention” of the human translator for “preserving naturalness and fluency”. According to another participant (P2), her ability “to make a hermeneutical analysis of the texts and guide AI in that respect” fostered her “self-concept as the human translator” as she was the one who decided “what kind of a translation is required and when it is acceptable”. The answer by another participant (P4) highlighted the “sense of empowerment and authority” she had while working with the tool in terms of responsibility.

This particular participant stated that she had asked the AI to take the responsibility of its translation but the AI denied responsibility by saying that “[I] strive to provide accurate and high-quality translations based on the text and context provided. However, the final responsibility for assessing and using the translations ultimately rests with the user or the person overseeing the translation project”. Another participant (P5) also underlined how she felt empowered by saying that “[t]he AI is clever and quick but it didn’t go through the life the way I did”. She also stated that the AI “knows everything about the world but has never actually seen it”, which was obvious in the AI’s translation of the essay “The Name is Mine”, which did not show any “sense of true-life experience”.

The answers to Question 4, “Upon completing the experiment, how would you assess the impact of your previous training and experience on the way you collaborate with the GenAI with a focus on your self-efficacy beliefs concerning your ability to prompt and guide the GenAI for producing translations of intended function?”, showed that most of the participants established a clear relationship between their previous training and experience and the way they worked with the GenAI. One participant (P3) stated that he believed that his previous experience and training was “vital during the experiment” and that if he had not “received any education in the field” it would be impossible for him “to guide the LLM”. Another participant (P1) stated that “providing the necessary prompt to the AI” requires “the holistic set of skills that constitute human translator competence” that can only be acquired by “translator training”, while another participant (P2) emphasised the significance of the knowledge of “text types and purpose of a translation” in effective prompt engineering. Another participant (P5) stated that thanks to her previous training and experience especially in working with and evaluating “automatic translation”, she “was able to spot what does not sound right as the translator and categorize these improvable aspects”. One participant (P4), on the other hand, stated that she has “come to understand that interacting with an AI is distinct from engaging with a human being”, which required skills different than the “social skills” needed to interact with other human beings.

The answers to Question 5, “Upon completing the experiment, do you have a clearer idea of the strengths and weaknesses of GenAI tools in terms of producing translations of intended function?”, revealed that the speed was the most appreciated feature of the tool. Yet, despite this, the participants highlighted the tool’s “weakness in terms of fluency” (P1) and its “inability to provide adequate translation outputs without feedback from a professional” (P3). One participant

(P5) stated that the tool is able to provide “usable output in many ways when guided accurately” but “it is not completely reliable” as it not fully possible to make the tool to “achieve what is in one’s mind”. One participant (P2) specifically referred to the text analysis ability of the GenAI tool as a strength. Similarly, another participant (P4) described the ability of the tool to “deliver rapid and deep analysis” as its “most notable strength”, however she also added, referring to the essay “The Name is Mine”, that the AI was “unable to convey the feminist perspective” in its translation no matter how hard she tried to prompt the tool in that direction.

The answers to Question 6, “Upon completing the experiment, how would you asses the contributive potential (if any) of GenAI tools for professional translation workflows?”, revealed that the participants mostly highlighted the time-saving benefits of the GenAI. One participant (P1) argued that “refining translations produced by GenAI through post-editing can save time” while another participant (P2) drew attention to the ability of the GenAI tools to yield “faster translation outputs compared to a fully human translation”. Another participant (P3) described the GenAI as a “great tool” as it is able to “efficiently analyse a text in detail”. The role the GenAI can play in the translation pre-process was also emphasised by another participant (P4), who stated that “AI can enhance the first stage in the translation process by offering comprehensive analysis to facilitate translation” and that it can assist the human translator “in the decision-making process by supplying necessary information”. One participant (P5), on the other hand, expressed her reservation, saying that GenAI “won’t be able to be professionally integrated into workflows until it is tailored to only translation projects”.

The answers to Question 7, “Upon completing the experiment, how would you define prompt engineering as an emergent job position for the human translator and the skills it requires?”, showed that the participants had gained a clear understanding of the requirements of prompt engineering as an emerging job position. Participant 5 stated that “the understanding of the translation process” is required to “excel in prompt engineering” together with “translation, language and technology competence” and “AI literacy”. Another participant (P3) stated that he believed that many human translators will become prompt engineers as “most LLMs can be customized according to different needs” and that such people will be necessary for “customising” and “upgrading” LLMs. Prompt engineering was regarded as “an essential and emerging role for human translators” by Participant 4, who also noted the importance of the re-consideration of “the effectiveness of communication skills in the context of prompt engineering” as

giving prompts is “directly linked to communicative abilities” of a human translator. One participant (P1) stated that without the human translator’s skills in “reading, understanding and analysing a text for translation purposes” and the skills in “reformulating a text in the target language in a way that it is appropriate for the purpose”, it would not be possible “to design the necessary prompts to guide the AI effectively”. The significance of prompt design was also highlighted by another participant (P2), who argued that apart from his/her existing skills, the human translator is required to develop his/her skills in prompting through experience.

The answers to Question 8, “Upon completing the experiment, what factors do you believe should be taken into consideration when integrating GenAI tools to translator education?”, displayed various considerations of the participants in terms of the integration of the GenAI to education. Participant 1 highlighted the importance of “instilling in the students the awareness that the importance and necessity of the human translator’s added value remain undiminished” as the human translator “retains the role as the expert and bears ultimate responsibility for the target text”. Another participant (P2) highlighted the necessity to “equip translation students with necessary qualifications to make an efficient use of GenAI tools” and to encourage them “to test the full potential of GenAI tools to participate in the technology development phase as well”. Another participant (P3) focused on the issues of “accuracy” and “bias”, which are frequently associated with LLMs, and stated that translation students “need to be able to critically evaluate AI-generated content and to efficiently conduct fact-checks, cultural appropriations, fitness for scope etc.” as LLMs “can generate outputs with factual errors, cultural insensitivity, or biases reflecting the data they were trained on”. A similar concern was present in the answer of another participant (P5), who stated that the AI’s “strengths and weaknesses and limitations (potential biases in training data, the possibility of factual errors, and the inability to capture cultural nuances) should be taken into account” in its integration into translator education. Another participant (P4) stated that, based on her experience in the experiment, “it is advisable to incorporate AI into translation-oriented text analysis courses”, also adding that the students need to be informed about the “potential disadvantages of relying only on AI, since it basically tends to produce “literal” translations.

The answers to Question 9, “Upon completing the experiment, what competences do you believe translation students should have to become experts of GenAI translation tasks?”, indicated that all participants agreed on the relevance of the

already established competences and skillsets of the human translator for becoming experts of GenAI translation tasks. Additionally, one participant (P2) drew attention to the emotional aspect involved in working with the GenAI and stated that it is necessary for students to learn to “control their emotions especially in the dialogues with the AI tools” because “by giving agency to the AI tool, the user attributes human features, which makes it even harder to control especially negative emotions”. Likewise, another participant (P4) stated that “the competence to communicate with the AI”, “emotional competence” and “post-editing competence” are fundamental and that “the quality of translation can be unavoidably influenced when there is a communication gap between a human translator and the AI”. Another participant (P3) stated that the students should be familiar with LLMs so that “they comfortably use different LLMs for translation, be aware of LLM related problems such as LLM hallucination or limitations of each LLM”. According to another participant (P5), “critical-thinking skills” and “creative skills” are needed in addition to “technological competence”, “editing competence”, “cultural competence”, and “research competence”.

The answers to Question 10, “Upon completing the experiment, what competences do you believe translator educators should have to educate students to become experts of GenAI translation tasks?”, displayed that a parallelism was established between the required competences of students and that of the educators (P4 and P5) in the context of integration of GenAI into translator education. According to one participant (P1), the translator educators need to engage in a “learning process themselves” by “closely following the developments in the field of AI”. Other participants stated that the educators should be “users of the state-of-the-art translation technologies” (P2) and should be “able to design courses that combine traditional translation practices with AI-assisted translation workflows” (P3).

Finally, only one participant (P4) provided an answer to Question 11, “Other comments”, in which she stated that the experiment helped her “identify” her “strengths and weaknesses as a human translator” as well as that of the GenAI. She also stated that “communicating and cooperating with the AI” was more “challenging” than she had anticipated and that “upon completing the experiment”, she identified herself “as a beginner but a quick learner when it comes to dancing with the AI” (P4, original emphasis).

5 Discussion and Conclusion

On the basis of the above analysis of the participants' answers to the questions, it can be claimed that the experiment provided the student-researchers with the opportunity to work with the GenAI to produce a functioning target text according to a given translation brief and, in doing so, to evaluate certain aspects of the human-GenAI dance through an experiment-based diagnosis of the strengths and weaknesses of the GenAI.

In the accounts of the participants, the primary strength associated with the GenAI was speed. Apart from this rather expected result, the participants laid special emphasis on the text analysis abilities of the GenAI, which was considered to be a significant factor that can facilitate and improve the translation process. On the negative side were the GenAI's inability to produce a stylistically adequate and fluent translation, its need for continuous prompting from a human translator, i.e. its failure to implement text-specific translation strategies unless a human translator guides it, its potential to generate outputs with bias, cultural insensitivity and factual errors, which can only be fixed by a careful monitoring and evaluation of a human translator, and last but not least, the GenAI's lack of a true-life experience.

The accounts further highlighted that during the experiment, the student-researchers re-evaluated their human added value and self-concept as educated and experienced translators. Despite their familiarity and experience with the dynamics of the human-MT interaction, they recognized the necessity of engaging in a new form of collaboration with the GenAI. Indeed, the participants' account of their own strengths and weaknesses were closely related to what they had found as strength and weakness in the GenAI technology. The need for the intervention, editing and evaluation of a professional human translator in turning a raw output from a GenAI tool to a functioning translation was emphasized by all the participants, echoing the findings of recent studies on the necessity of a human translator's intervention due to the limitations of the GenAI (e.g. Alimen, SÖBNA). Thus, the process by which the students adjusted the GenAI output through prompt engineering mirrors the hermeneutic role of the human translator, who interprets the 'meaning' of a text and reframes it appropriately for the target audience, which would underscore that GenAI-assisted translation is not merely mechanical but requires deep cultural adjustments and human judgment.

The participants also highlighted the sense of empowerment and authority they felt as decision-makers, who must make decisions concerning translation strategies and prompt the GenAI tool accordingly, and the sense of responsibility such power brings along. Such sense of responsibility and authority in finalizing translation outputs aligns with the ethical and hermeneutic roles of the human translator. This being said, some of the participants also addressed areas of self-improvement such as developing skills to communicate with the GenAI, which is distinct from communicating with a human being, and to design and curate effective prompts to guide the AI through the translation process without getting impatient and stressed. This gives hints about the possible emotional challenges human translators can face while working with the GenAI, evidencing the need for “introducing an emotional intelligence dimension into translator training” (J.:349), which should certainly be addressed in future research on the integration of GenAI into translator education.

The analysis of the results also provided insights into other factors to be considered in such integration. All student-researchers, who were trained translators with experience, acknowledged the significance of their previous education and experience in performing the emerging task of prompt engineering. It was also agreed upon by the participants that for effective prompt engineering, the holistic set of skills of a trained professional human translator is a prerequisite, which has also been suggested in a recent study on the role of human competencies in the “tech-driven language services industry” (İşinÖner:92). Yet it was also noted by most of the participants that, in addition to this prerequisite, translation students should be educated to be able to effectively communicate with/prompt the GenAI, to critically evaluate and edit its output and to develop an awareness of the fact that the human translator is still the ultimate authority with the right to final say by virtue of the trust and responsibility placed on him/her, which underscores the importance of recognizing the translator’s active role in reconstructing cultural value and meaning within the interactive translation processes enabled by GenAI and that hermeneutic-based education offers a valuable approach for fostering a deeper understanding of the human translator’s role in GenAI translation.

This, in turn, places further responsibility on the translation educator, who, according to the participants’ accounts, needs to become a dedicated learner and user of the state-of-the-art GenAI technology in order to integrate it into the translation classroom, where his/her students can cautiously but confidently communicate and dance with the GenAI.

23 *Re-positioning the human translator as the future expert of GenAI translation in the translation classroom: The results of a collaborative study*

These experience-based insights, which were gained through a collaborative research experiment, shed light on the emerging opportunities, as well as challenges, for re-positioning the human translator as the future expert of GenAI translation in the translation classroom. They further show a possible path to the fulfilment of the translator educator-researcher's, also emerging, task of re-seeing *what is/will remain human in translation* and incorporating it into education in the age of GenAI.

Appendix 1. Instructions for process report writing

Please write your report by answering the below questions.

1. What is your general assessment of the experiment?
2. Upon completing the experiment, have you faced any emotional challenges as a human agent collaborating with the GenAI to produce a translation?
3. Upon completing the experiment, what have you discovered about your power vis-à-vis the AI and your self-concept as a human translator?
4. Upon completing the experiment, how would you assess the impact of your previous training and experience on the way you collaborate with the GenAI with a focus on your self-efficacy beliefs concerning your ability to prompt and guide the GenAI for producing translations of intended function?
5. Upon completing the experiment, do you have a clearer idea of the strengths and weaknesses of GenAI tools in terms of producing translations of intended function?
6. Upon completing the experiment, how would you assess the contributive potential (if any) of GenAI tools for professional translation workflows?
7. Upon completing the experiment, how would you define prompt engineering as an emergent job position for the human translator and the skills it requires?
8. Upon completing the experiment, what factors do you believe should be taken into consideration when integrating GenAI tools to translator education?
9. Upon completing the experiment, what competences do you believe translation students should have to become experts of GenAI translation tasks?
10. Upon completing the experiment, what competences do you believe translator educators should have to educate students to become experts of GenAI translation tasks?
11. Other comments